

Boyd C. Ruamcharoen

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Academic Appointments

2025–27 Harvard University, Cambridge, MA
Charles Warren Center for Studies in American History
Postdoctoral Fellow in Global American Studies

Education

2025 Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Cambridge, MA
Ph.D. in History, Anthropology, and Science, Technology and Society (HASTS)

2015 Swarthmore College, Swarthmore, PA
B.A. in Sociology and Anthropology, with a minor in Interpretation Theory

Publications

Monographs

Empire of Rot: Weatherability, U.S. Power, and the Postcolonial Tropics. In preparation.

Peer-Reviewed Articles

“Rotten Analogies: Climatic Analogs and the U.S. Military’s Management of Tropical Decay from World War II to the Vietnam War,” *Environment and Planning E: Nature and Space*, special issue on “Militarized Landscapes” (advance online publication, 2026): 1–26, <https://doi.org/10.1177/25148486261434094>.

“Tropicalizing the Portable Radio: Electronics and the U.S. Military’s Battle Against Fungi in the Pacific War,” *Technology and Culture* 65, no. 2 (2024): 497–529, <https://doi.org/10.1353/tech.2024.a926313>.

- **Maurice Daumas Prize** for the best article in the history of technology
- **Bernard S. Finn IEEE History Prize** for the best article in the history of electrotechnology

Selected Academic Honors

Prizes

2026 **Maurice Daumas Prize** (for “Tropicalizing the Portable Radio”) International Committee for the History of Technology (ICHTEC), for the best published paper in the history of technology by an emerging scholar

2026 **Edward M. Coffman First-Manuscript Prize**, Honorable Mention Society for Military History (SMH), for the best dissertation in military history

- 2025 **Bernard S. Finn IEEE History Prize** (for “Tropicalizing the Portable Radio”) Society for the History of Technology (SHOT), for the best published paper in the history of electrotechnology

External Grants and Fellowships

- 2026 **William Appleman Williams Emerging Scholar Grant**
Society for Historians of American Foreign Relations (SHAFR)
- 2024–25 **Taylor-Wei Dissertation Fellowship in the History of Meteorology**
Department of History of Science, Technology, and Medicine, University of Oklahoma
- 2023 **Lemelson Center for the Study of Invention and Innovation Fellowship**
National Museum of American History (NMAH), Smithsonian Institution
- 2023 **Samuel Flagg Bemis Dissertation Research Grant**
Society for Historians of American Foreign Relations (SHAFR)
- 2022 **Henry Belin du Pont Fellowship**
Hagley Museum and Library
- 2022 **Research Fellowship**
Consortium for History of Science, Technology, and Medicine (CHSTM)

Latest Presentations and Conference Activities (Since 2024)

Conference and Workshop Presentations

- 2026 “The Paradox of a Weatherable Empire,” Infrastructures of Global American Power, **Society for Historians of American Foreign Relations (SHAFR) Annual Meeting**, Columbus, OH, June 25–27
- 2026 “Environmentalism in Decay: The Rise of Biodegradable Materials and the U.S. Empire’s Science of Durability, 1960s–70s,” Technological Environmentalisms, **American Society for Environmental History (ASEH) Annual Meeting**, Kansas City, MO, March 25–28
- 2025 “Weathering Decolonization: Tropical Standards of Durability and Postcolonial Worldmaking, 1947–1970s,” Building the Non-Aligned World, **Society for the History of Technology (SHOT) Annual Meeting**, Esch-sur-Alzette, Luxembourg, October 9–11
- 2025 “Weathering Decolonization: Weatherable Materials and the Making of Tropical Futures,” The Environment and Worldmaking, **Society for Historians of American Foreign Relations (SHAFR) Annual Meeting**, Arlington, VA, June 26–28
- 2025 Roundtable Participant, Envirotech Roundtable: Past, Present, and Future Directions, **American Society of Environmental History (ASEH) Annual Meeting**, Pittsburgh, PA, April 9–13
- 2024 “Empire’s Deadwood: Decomposing Vegetation in the American Imperium,” Decaying and Decomposing Knowledge, **History of Science Society (HSS) Annual Meeting**, Mérida, Yucatán, Mexico, November 7–10

- 2024 Roundtable Participant, The Habitat of Empire: How U.S. Power Shaped the Environment and Vice Versa, **Society for Historians of American Foreign Relations (SHAFR) Annual Meeting**, Toronto, Canada, June 13–15
- 2024 “Deteriorating Relations: The Deterioration of Materials and U.S. Global Environmental Management,” Pathologies of Materials, **American Society for Environmental History (ASEH) Annual Meeting**, Denver, CO, April 3–7

Teaching Experience

Instructor of Record

- Spring 2026 **Ecologies of American Empire, 1898–2000**
Department of History, Harvard University

Teaching Assistant

- Spring 2023 **Cultures of Computing**
Program in Science, Technology, and Society (STS), MIT
- Fall 2021 **The Indigenous History of MIT**
History Section, MIT
- Fall 2020 **Technology and Culture**
Anthropology Program, MIT
- Spring 2020 **Science in Action: Technologies and Controversies in Everyday Life**
Program in Science, Technology, and Society (STS), MIT

Guest Instructor

- Fall 2025 “Environmental History and Empire,” **Empires and Colonies in the Twentieth Century**
Department of History, University of Notre Dame
Assigned Reading: *Deteriorating Relations* (Ph.D. dissertation, MIT, 2025)
- Fall 2025 “Nature as Infrastructure,” **Infrastructures**, Fall 2025
Program in Science, Technology, and Society (STS), Tufts University
- Spring 2024 “The U.S. Military and the Tropical Environment,” **U.S. Environmental Governance**
History Section, MIT

Pedagogical Training

- Spring 2024 **Kaufman Teaching Certificate Program (KTCP)**
Teaching and Learning Lab (TLL), MIT

Academic and Community Service

Professional Service

- 2025– Co-convenor, Envirotech Special Interest Group, American Society for Environmental History (ASEH) and the Society for the History of Technology (SHOT)
- 2024–25 Co-founder and Editor, [ContraSTS Magazine](#)

Institutional Service

- 2024–25 Student Representative, History Section, MIT
- 2024–25 Student Coordinator, Seminar on Environmental and Agricultural History (SEAH), MIT
- 2022 Programmer and Organizer, Cross-sts Seminar Series, MIT